11-16 第1篇

# 阅读理解（说明文） Why Does My Stomach Growl When I Am Hungry?

① There is a small, secret language that my stomach speaks during the fourth lesson on a Tuesday morning. Around 11:25, exactly forty-five minutes before lunch, the quiet classroom is broken by a long, low sound from the front row. Everyone turns. The boy in the blue hoodie blushes red to the tips of his ears. A minute later, my own stomach, not to be left out, joins in. In English, this sound is called a **stomach growl**; in Chinese we call it 肚子咕咕叫. It is one of the most embarrassing sounds in middle school — and, as I recently learned, one of the most misunderstood.

② The first thing worth knowing: **stomach growls are not only about hunger**. The sound does come from the **stomach and the small intestine**, but what really makes it happen is not an empty tummy — it is the **movement of muscle waves** along the inner wall of the digestive tube. These waves, called **peristalsis**, are always running, quietly, day and night, pushing food, liquid, and gas through our bodies. When there is **a lot of food** in the stomach, the food muffles the sound, the way a sofa muffles a slammed door. When the stomach is mostly **empty**, the sound of the same waves is clear, loud, and travels out through our thin belly wall.

③ Here is where our brain becomes the director of this small concert. The inside of the stomach is always checking: "Is there food here?" If the stomach has been empty for about **two hours**, a small chemical called **ghrelin** is released into the blood. Ghrelin does two things: it travels to the brain and tells us "you are getting hungry", and it tells the stomach muscles to **push harder** — a kind of "tidy-up wave" called **Migrating Motor Complex (MMC)**. MMC sweeps the stomach clean, getting it ready for the next meal. Because the stomach is empty, the strong sweep creates a loud, low gurgling — and we hear it at exactly the moment we begin to feel hungry.

④ This is why we associate the sound with hunger: it is not that the stomach "cries for food", it is that the stomach is **doing its cleaning** precisely when hunger starts. In other words, the growl is not a complaint; it is a **careful, responsible routine**. Your stomach, on the way to lunch, is politely wiping its own kitchen floor.

⑤ Can we predict a growl? Partly yes. Notice three simple things. **First, time since last meal.** The MMC begins to strengthen about **90—120 minutes** after a meal. **Second, stress.** Stress — a surprise test, a public speaking moment — makes the MMC stronger in many students; the class may hear the loudest growl during the fourth lesson, not the fifth. **Third, gas.** A breakfast of cold milk, beans, or bubbly drinks makes more gas, and

gas is what gives the growl its deep **"g-r-r-r"** tone. Without gas, the sound would be almost nothing.

⑥ A common myth says: "If I drink a lot of water, my stomach will stop growling." In fact, water helps for only **ten to twenty minutes**. Water moves quickly out of the stomach, so the MMC returns to its work. A **small snack** — a few nuts, a slice of whole-meal bread, a banana — is more effective, because **real food slows the cleaning wave**. If your teacher allows a short mid-morning snack at 10:20, you will almost certainly not hear a growl at 11:25.

⑦ Another worry is whether a loud growl means something is **wrong with our stomach**. For 95% of students, the answer is "no". A growl is perfectly healthy. The two warning signs to watch are (1) **frequent growling plus strong pain** that wakes you at night, and (2) **growling together with feeling faint**. These should be reported to the school nurse. Otherwise, the sound is simply the quiet music of a working body.

⑧ My advice to my classmate in the blue hoodie — and to every embarrassed fourth-lesson stomach in every school corridor on Earth — is this: your stomach is not betraying you. It is **working hard for you**. It is cleaning itself, getting ready for the meal that is still fifteen minutes away, and quietly asking the brain to send you to the dining hall on time. When you hear the growl next Tuesday morning, smile slightly, not at the boy in the blue hoodie, but at the small, hardworking stomach inside your own coat. "Thank you," you may say silently. "I will bring you something warm in fifteen minutes." **A polite sound, it turns out, deserves a polite reply.**

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**注释：** stomach growl 肚子咕咕叫；peristalsis 蠕动；ghrelin 生长激素释放肽（饥饿素）；MMC 移行性复合运动波；myth 迷思

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**根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。**

**1. What really makes a stomach growl?**

A. The stomach shouting because it is empty.
B. The movement of muscle waves (peristalsis) along the inner wall of the digestive tube; when the stomach is full, food muffles the sound; when it is empty, the same waves are loud and clear through the thin belly wall.
C. A small whistle inside the throat.
D. A heart sound.

**2. What role does ghrelin play in a stomach growl?**

A. Ghrelin has nothing to do with hunger.
B. After about two hours of emptiness, ghrelin is released into the blood; it tells the brain "you are getting hungry" and tells the stomach to push harder — a strong "tidy-up wave" (Migrating Motor Complex), which, in an empty stomach, makes a loud gurgling at

exactly the moment hunger starts.
C. Ghrelin fills the stomach with food.
D. Ghrelin is only made after eating.

**3. Which of the following is NOT one of the three things that help predict a growl?**

A. How long since the last meal (MMC strengthens 90—120 minutes after a meal).
B. Stress.
C. The amount of gas produced by the breakfast.
D. The colour of the student's clothes.

**4. Why does drinking a lot of water NOT really stop a stomach growl?**

A. Because water does not reach the stomach.
B. Because water moves quickly out of the stomach and the MMC returns to its work after only 10—20 minutes; a small snack (nuts, whole-meal bread, a banana) works better, because real food slows the cleaning wave.
C. Because water makes more gas.
D. Because water blocks the stomach.

**5. According to the passage, when should a student tell the school nurse about growls?**

A. Every time she hears a growl in class.
B. When she has frequent growls together with strong pain that wakes her at night, or growls with feeling faint.
C. When she eats breakfast.
D. When the classroom is quiet.

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# 答案与解析

**1.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "peristalsis ... muffles ... thin belly wall"
【解析】发声机制直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

**2.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段饥饿素与 MMC
【解析】功能直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

**3.**
【答案】D

【题型】细节理解题（否定）
【定位】第⑤段三条预测因素
【解析】A、B、C 均在文中；D 未提及。故选 D。

**4.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "10—20 minutes ... small snack"
【解析】水与零食对比直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

**5.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段两个警示信号
【解析】医学警告直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。